

THE PARAGON

A Homebrew Class for Dungeons & Dragons 5th Edition

Powers awaken. Some are born with them, others discover them in a moment of crisis. The Paragon channels an innate, mutant power source through Genetic Potential — an ever-growing well of ability expressed through martial Powered Strikes and a chosen Hero Archetype. Five archetypes exist: the blistering speed of the Streak, the web-slinging acrobatics of the Web, the mind-bending focus of the Weave, the unstoppable strength of the Brick, and the elemental fury of the Tempest.

THE PARAGON — BASE CLASS

Hit Die: d10 | Primary Ability: Strength or Dexterity | Saving Throws: Strength, Constitution

Magic in Avara is old, dangerous, and tightly bound to bloodlines, pacts, and places of power — vampires, fae courts, wolves, witches, the works. A Paragon doesn't fit any of those boxes. Genetic Potential is something stranger: a power that simply is, awakened in an ordinary person rather than inherited through a known lineage or granted by a patron. Nobody has a name for what a Paragon is when one first appears — not witch, not blessed, not cursed — so the world reaches for the nearest story it has and calls them a hero, a monster, or a miracle, depending on who's watching and what they just did with their powers. That ambiguity is the heart of the class: a Paragon has to choose to be a hero. Nothing about the power itself makes that choice for them.

Proficiencies

Armor: Light armor, medium armor, shields

Weapons: Simple weapons, martial weapons

Tools: None

Saving Throws: Strength, Constitution

Skills: Choose 2 from Acrobatics, Athletics, Insight, Intimidation, Investigation, Perception, Persuasion, Stealth

Starting Equipment

- a martial weapon or a simple weapon and a shield, or two simple weapons
- a signature costume, mask, or civilian disguise kit
- a set of common clothes for a secret identity
- an explorer's pack
- 5d4 x 10 in starting currency

Class Progression

Lvl	Prof	Features	Genes Known	Genetic Potential
1	+2	Powered Strike, Hero Archetype, 2 Genes Known	2	—
2	+2	Genetic Potential online	2	Level + Con mod
3	+2	Archetype feature	3	Level + Con mod
4	+2	Ability Score Improvement	3	Level + Con mod
5	+3	Extra Attack (2 attacks), Powered Strike die → 1d8	4	Level + Con mod
6	+3	Archetype feature	4	Level + Con mod
7	+3	Adaptive Instinct	5	Level + Con mod
8	+3	Ability Score Improvement	5	Level + Con mod
9	+4	Archetype Ultimate	6	Level + Con mod
10	+4	Powered Strike die → 1d10, Genetic Surge	6	Level + Con mod + 2
11	+4	Extra Attack II (3 attacks)	7	Level + Con mod + 2
12	+4	Ability Score Improvement	7	Level + Con mod + 2
13	+5	Overcharged Genes	8	Level + Con mod + 2
14	+5	Genetic Surge II	8	Level + Con mod + 4

Lvl	Prof	Features	Genes Known	Genetic Potential
15	+5	Archetype feature	9	Level + Con mod + 4
16	+5	Ability Score Improvement	9	Level + Con mod + 4
17	+6	Extra Attack III (4 attacks), Powered Strike die → 1d12	10	Level + Con mod + 4
18	+6	—	10	Level + Con mod + 4
19	+6	Ability Score Improvement	11	Level + Con mod + 4
20	+6	Apex Potential (capstone)	11	Level + Con mod + 4

Core Features

Powered Strike (Level 1)

Your basic attack. Deals 1d6 (scaling to 1d8 at 5th, 1d10 at 10th, 1d12 at 17th) plus your ability modifier and your proficiency bonus.

Hero Archetype (Level 1)

Choose your archetype (Streak, The Web, The Weave, The Brick, or The Tempest) at 1st level. This choice is permanent.

Genetic Potential (Level 2)

Your resource pool for Genes that cost points, equal to your Paragon level plus your Constitution modifier.

Extra Attack (Level 5)

You can attack twice, instead of once, when you take the Attack action.

Adaptive Instinct (Level 7)

When you take damage from a source you've already been damaged by earlier in the same encounter, you gain resistance to that damage type until the end of your next turn. Triggers automatically, no action required.

Genetic Surge (Level 10)

Your Genetic Potential maximum increases by 2.

Extra Attack II (Level 11)

You can attack three times when you take the Attack action.

Overcharged Genes (Level 13)

Once per short rest, you can use a Gene that costs Genetic Potential without spending any points from your pool.

Genetic Surge II (Level 14)

Your Genetic Potential maximum increases by 2 (stacking with Genetic Surge). Once per long rest, when your Genetic Potential is reduced to 0, you can immediately regain half your maximum (round up) as part of the triggering action.

Extra Attack III (Level 17)

You can attack four times when you take the Attack action.

Apex Potential (Level 20)

Choose two ability scores; each increases by 2, to a maximum of 24. Once per long rest, you can use two Genes as part of the same action without spending Genetic Potential for either.

UNIVERSAL GENES

Genes are the powers your Paragon knows, chosen from the universal list below or from your archetype's exclusive list. At-will Genes have no cost; others cost Genetic Potential.

At-Will

Adrenal Surge — At-Will, Bonus Action

Gain advantage on your next Strength or Dexterity check or save made before the end of your turn.

Iron Skin — At-Will, Reaction

Reduce damage taken by your proficiency bonus. Usable once per turn.

Reflexive Sense — At-Will, Passive

You can't be surprised while conscious, and add your proficiency bonus to initiative.

Powered Leap — At-Will, Passive

Your jump distance is tripled; no fall damage from falls of 20 feet or less.

Genetic Potential Cost

Kinetic Burst — 1 GP

As part of a Powered Strike hit: push the target 10 feet.

Focused Mind — 1 GP, Bonus Action

Advantage on Wisdom or Intelligence saves until start of your next turn.

Overwhelm — 1 GP

On a Powered Strike hit: target has disadvantage on its next save before the end of your next turn.

Second Wind (Genetic) — 2 GP, Bonus Action

Regain 1d10 + Paragon level hit points.

Sensory Overload — 1 GP, Action

One creature within 30 feet: Con save or blinded and deafened until end of its next turn.

Unbreakable Stance — 1 GP, Reaction

Negate being knocked prone, pushed, or pulled.

Aura of Presence — 2 GP, Action

Up to 3 creatures within 30 feet gain advantage on their next attack or save.

Emergency Output — All remaining GP (min. 1), Reaction

When reduced to 0 HP, drop to 1 HP instead. Once per long rest.

STREAK

The speedster — blistering velocity, momentum given weight, a blur that leaves afterimages behind.

Archetype Features

Kinetic Instinct (Level 1)

+10 ft. speed; reaction dodge-blur against attacks.

Blur Step (signature Gene) (Level 1)

Bonus action, at-will: 15-foot teleport-dash.

Momentum (Level 3)

Whenever you move at least 20 feet in a turn, gain a Momentum die (1d4+1, upgrading to 1d6+1 at 9th level), banked up to 4. You can expend one banked die as part of any attack to add its result to the damage.

Time-Slip (Level 6)

Advantage on Dexterity or Strength saving throws. If you beat the save DC by 5 or more, negate the effect entirely.

Flash Time (Ultimate) (Level 9)

Once per long rest: take an extra full turn immediately.

Afterimage (Level 15)

When you use Flash Time, attackers targeting you must choose between you and a lingering afterimage; targeting the afterimage automatically misses. Once per long rest, usable standalone as a bonus action.

Streak-Exclusive Genes

At-Will

Redline — At-Will

Treat a spent Momentum die as its maximum result (5, or 7 at 9th level) instead of rolling.

Skid Stop — At-Will

When you end your movement, drop all banked Momentum dice to gain that much movement back (reaction).

Genetic Potential Cost

Full Tilt — 1 GP

As part of movement: speed doubles until end of turn; Momentum dice gained this turn rolled with advantage.

Velocity Lash — 1 GP

On a Powered Strike hit after moving 20+ feet: extra 1d6 damage per banked Momentum die (max 3d6).

Phase Run — 2 GP

Move through creatures/objects for the rest of your turn.

Echo Step — 1 GP, Reaction

When an enemy misses you: move up to (Momentum dice) x 5 feet without provoking.

Streak Magic Items

Boots of the Racing Pulse

Uncommon, Attunement

Walking speed +10 ft. Momentum triggers on any 20+ feet of movement in a turn, even non-straight-line.

Chronowoven Sash

Rare, Attunement

Once per short rest, bonus action: gain a Momentum die without moving first.

Tachyon Circuit Anklets

Very Rare, Attunement

Once per short rest, reaction to being hit: move half your speed before damage is calculated; if this removes you from range/sight, the attack misses.

The Golden Chronoarmor

Legendary, Attunement

When you use Flash Time, take the extra turn immediately, then another normal turn at your regular initiative spot (once per long rest). Your primary ability score is treated as 2 higher for Powered Strike attack and damage rolls.

THE WEB

The agile web-slinger — evasion, repositioning, and battlefield puppetry over raw force.

Archetype Features

Adhesive Grip (Level 1)

Climbing speed equal to walking speed; no damage from unintentional falls.

Web Line (signature Gene) (Level 1)

Bonus action, at-will, 30 ft: Swing (move 30 ft, no opportunity attacks) or Snag (pull an ally free of danger, or force a Str save on a hostile creature to pull it 15 ft or halve its speed).

Web-Sense (Level 3)

Advantage on Dex saves; can't be surprised. Prof. bonus times per short rest, reaction: impose disadvantage on an incoming attack roll.

Tangled Strikes (Level 3)

Powered Strike hits apply a stacking Webbing condition (max 3), each reducing speed by 10 ft. Clearing all stacks costs the target its action. Hitting an already-maxed target splashes a stack onto another creature within 10 feet instead.

Safety Line (Level 6)

Reaction: yank an ally within 30 feet out of an attack's reach or a hazard; can cause the triggering attack to automatically miss.

Ensnare / Binding Web (Level 6)

Snag can fully restrain (Str save, DC 8 + prof + Con); restraining applies 2 Webbing stacks.

Master Weaver (Ultimate) (Level 9)

Once per long rest: fill a 30-ft cube with webbing (difficult terrain, restrain on entry); reposition already-restrained creatures within it.

Overwhelmed (Level 11)

At 3 Webbing stacks, the target's AC is also reduced by 2 while it holds all 3.

Weaver's Instinct (Level 15)

Web-Sense's reaction is now unlimited. A successful disadvantage-miss lets you use Web Line for free as part of the same reaction.

The Web-Exclusive Genes

At-Will

Zip Line — At-Will

When using Swing, bring one willing ally within 5 feet along for the move.

Sticky Landing — At-Will

When you land from a fall or Swing, make one free Powered Strike against a creature within 5 feet.

Genetic Potential Cost

Web Shield — 1 GP, Reaction

Impose disadvantage on an attack targeting you or an ally within 30 feet.

Pinning Shot — 1 GP

A Webbing stack also gives the target disadvantage on attacks against anyone but you.

Cocoon — 2 GP, Action

A restrained creature can't take actions or reactions until the start of your next turn.

Web Anchor — 1 GP, Reaction

Halve forced movement distance on a creature within 30 feet.

The Web Magic Items

Web-Slinger's Cartridges

Uncommon, Attunement

Wrist launchers. Action: fire webbing at a point within 60 feet, creating a swingable anchor. 3 charges/dawn.

Adaptive Web-Suit

Rare, Attunement

Web Line's range increases to 60 ft. Once per short rest, Snag two creatures within 15 feet of each other with one use.

Weaver's Mantle

Very Rare, Attunement

Once per long rest, when you restrain a creature, simultaneously web up to two others within 10 feet.

Aranea's Loom

Legendary, Attunement

Master Weaver usable twice per long rest. While your webbing exists, teleport to any point in it as a bonus action, once per turn.

THE WEAVE

The telepath — a ranged psychic blaster whose confusion effects unravel an enemy's mind.

Archetype Features

Mind Blast (Level 1)

Your Powered Strike can be made at range (60 ft) instead of melee, dealing psychic damage. Applies to every attack, including from Extra Attack.

Telepathic Bond (Level 1)

At-will telepathy with any creature sharing a language, within 60 feet.

Fracture (Level 3)

On a Powered Strike hit, Int or Wis save (your choice, DC 8 + prof + Cha) or the target is Fractured until the end of its next turn: 1-2 on a d6 wastes its action, 3-4 forces it to target the nearest creature, 5-6 acts normally. Only 1 Fractured target at a time.

Deepen the Fracture (Level 6)

Maintain Fracture on up to 2 creatures. A failed save also gives disadvantage on saves against your other Weave features.

Mind Storm (Ultimate) (Level 9)

Once per long rest: 30-ft radius, 4d6 psychic damage and a Fracture save (repeating each turn) for 1 minute. No cap on simultaneous Fractures from this effect.

Puppeteer (Level 15)

Once per long rest, override a Fractured creature's d6 roll: dictate its action instead (move, attack with advantage, or drop an item).

The Weave-Exclusive Genes

At-Will

Levitation Field — At-Will

Flying speed equal to walking speed (hover-flight — must end turn within 5 feet of a surface).

Whisper Read — At-Will

Action: read the surface thoughts of a creature within 30 feet (no save, but detectable via Insight vs. your Deception).

Genetic Potential Cost

Piercing Thought — 1 GP

Mind Blast ignores psychic resistance; treats immunity as resistance.

Echoing Fracture — 1 GP

On a failed Fracture save, one other creature within 10 feet must also save or become Fractured.

Silence the Mind — 2 GP, Reaction

Force a reroll of a save you'd make against an incoming mental effect, choosing the result.

Shattering Presence — 1 GP, Bonus Action

Your next Powered Strike against a Fractured creature deals an extra 2d6 psychic damage.

The Weave Magic Items

Circlet of Whispers

Uncommon, Attunement

Telepathic Bond's range increases to 120 feet. Advantage on Insight checks to detect lies from a linked creature.

Fractured Lens

Rare, Attunement

Once per short rest, a creature hit by Mind Blast has disadvantage on its Fracture save.

Crown of the Puppeteer

Very Rare, Attunement

Once per long rest, bonus action: apply Fracture to a creature within 30 feet with no attack roll or save.

Diadem of the Hive Mind

Legendary, Attunement

Maintain Fracture on any number of creatures simultaneously. Share Telepathic Bond with up to 3 willing allies.

THE BRICK

The strongman — a bruiser/grappler hybrid who beats enemies to a pulp while holding them down.

Archetype Features

Titan's Grip (Level 1)

Grapple creatures up to two sizes larger than you (Huge, at 1st level). Advantage on Athletics checks to grapple or shove; carry/lift capacity doubled. Grapple as part of a Powered Strike hit instead of using your action.

Crushing Hold (Level 1)

Grappled creatures take 1d6 bludgeoning at the start of their turn; no free hand/weapon needed to strike them.

Overpower (Level 3)

Powered Strikes against a grappled target deal an extra 1d6 damage; target has disadvantage on escape checks. Regain HP equal to a third of the total damage dealt this way.

Twin Grip (Level 6)

Grapple cap increases to Gargantuan; grapple up to 2 creatures at once. Lifesteal increases to half. Action: slam two grappled creatures together (2d6, Con save or stunned).

Seismic Slam (Ultimate) (Level 9)

Once per long rest: slam a grappled creature into the ground (4d10, grapple ends) with a 15-ft AoE (Str save for half, or knocked prone). Doesn't require an existing grapple.

Unstoppable Force (Level 15)

Uncapped grapple size; advantage on Str saves; immune to forced movement while grappling. Lifesteal increases to two-thirds. Once per long rest, drop to 1 HP instead of 0 while grappling.

The Brick-Exclusive Genes

At-Will

Growth Spurt — At-Will

Bonus action: grow to Large, +1d4 damage, +5 ft. reach, disadvantage on Dex saves, until ended.

Iron Grip — At-Will

A creature you have grappled is immune to all forced movement and teleportation.

Genetic Potential Cost

Colossal Growth — 2 GP, Bonus Action

As Growth Spurt, but Huge size, +2d4 damage, +10 ft. reach. 1 minute.

Aftershock — 1 GP

+2 to the save DC of your slam / Seismic Slam effects.

Feeding Frenzy — 1 GP, Bonus Action

Your next Powered Strike against your grapple target automatically hits.

Human Shield — 1 GP, Reaction

Redirect an attack targeting your grapple victim to yourself instead.

The Brick Magic Items

Gauntlets of the Iron Grip

Uncommon, Attunement

Advantage on checks to maintain a grapple; grappled targets have disadvantage on escape attempts.

Girdle of Titan Strength

Rare, Attunement

Strength becomes 21 if not already higher. +1 to slam-effect save DCs.

Plates of the Unmovable

Very Rare, Attunement

While grappling: resistance to nonmagical B/P/S damage; can't be knocked prone.

Titan's Core

Legendary, Attunement

While grappling, Strength is treated as 24. Once per long rest, Seismic Slam doesn't require a prior grapple and its area increases to 30 feet.

THE TEMPEST

The elemental — choose Fire, Cold, or Lightning at character creation (permanent). All three share identical core damage math; each element's flavor comes through its rider effects.

Archetype Features

Elemental Affinity (Level 1)

Choose Fire, Cold, or Lightning. Powered Strike deals your element's damage; you have resistance to it, and your damage ignores resistance / treats immunity as resistance.

Elemental Mark (Level 1)

On hit, apply a stack of your Mark (max 1 at this level). At the END of the marked creature's turn, it takes 1d4 damage of your element and the mark ends. Cold: speed is halved until the mark triggers. Lightning: you may arc half the tick damage to another creature within 10 feet when the mark triggers.

Elemental Surge (Level 3)

Mark can stack to 3; tick die becomes 1d6 per stack. Cold: triggering at 3 stacks forces a Con save or the target is restrained in ice. Lightning: the arc no longer halves damage at 3 stacks.

Elemental Mastery (Level 6)

Fire: tick deals an extra 1d6 if the target didn't move that turn. Cold: you ignore your own ice terrain; ice-restrained targets have vulnerability to your damage. Lightning: the arc no longer requires 3 stacks and always hits one additional target at full damage.

Elemental Cataclysm (Ultimate) (Level 9)

Once per long rest: 30-ft radius, 6d6 damage of your element (save for half) plus a field effect — Fire leaves burning difficult terrain, Cold restrains on a failed save, Lightning hits every creature at full, uncapped damage.

Elemental Avatar (Level 15)

Immunity to your element. Fire: adjacent creatures take 2d6 at the start of your turn. Cold: creatures ending their turn within 5 feet take 2d6 and have speed halved (Con save). Lightning: reaction-teleport up to 30 feet once per turn when hit; creatures near your path take 2d6.

The Tempest-Exclusive Genes

At-Will

Elemental Reach — At-Will

Powered Strike can be made against a target within 10 feet without requiring melee range.

Attuned Resistance — At-Will

Resistance to the two elemental damage types you didn't choose.

Genetic Potential Cost

Overload — 1 GP

A newly applied Mark stack's tick damage resolves immediately instead of at end of turn.

Elemental Wave — 2 GP, Action

Fire: 15-ft cone. Cold: 30-ft line. Lightning: bolt arcing to up to 3 targets within 10 feet of each other. Dex save; 2d6 damage and a Mark stack on a failure, half damage and no Mark on a success.

Double Mark — 1 GP, Bonus Action

Your next Powered Strike this turn applies 2 Mark stacks instead of 1.

Elemental Feedback — 1 GP, Reaction

When you take damage of a type you resist, regain HP equal to half the damage prevented.

The Tempest Magic Items

Cloak of the Storm's Herald

Uncommon, Attunement

Elemental Wave's area increases by 5 feet.

Core of the Undying [Element]

Rare, Attunement

Once per short rest, applying a Mark stack applies an additional stack at the same time.

Cinderheart Catalyst

Very Rare, Attunement

(Renamed and reflavored to match your chosen element — Frostheart / Stormheart.) As Core of the Undying, at a stronger, more reliable rate — GM to set exact frequency.

Heart of the Primal Storm

Legendary, Attunement

Elemental Cataclysm usable once per short rest instead of long rest. Elemental Mark stacks no longer cap at 3. Your primary ability score is treated as 2 higher for Powered Strike attack and damage rolls.

PARAGON FEATS

Superhero-moment-inspired feats, available to any Paragon.

Not Today

As a reaction when an attack would reduce an ally within 30 feet to 0 hit points, move up to your speed toward them (ignoring opportunity attacks) and take the damage instead. Once per short rest.

This Ends Now

Your Powered Strike deals an extra die of its damage type against a creature at half its hit point maximum or below.

With Great Power

Whenever you reduce a creature to 0 hit points, regain 1 point of Genetic Potential (up to your maximum).

Big Damn Hero

If you enter combat by moving at least 20 feet toward the fight on your first turn, your first attack that turn has advantage.

Team-Up

Once per turn, when you hit a creature an ally has already hit this round, your attack deals an extra 1d6 damage.

Never Give Up

When reduced to 0 hit points but not killed outright, you can choose to drop to 1 hit point instead. Once per long rest.

Signature Move

Choose one Gene you know that costs Genetic Potential. Once per long rest, use it without spending any points.

Everyone's Hero

Whenever you spend your action, reaction, or movement protecting, saving, or explicitly not harming an ally or bystander at some cost to your own tactical position, gain temporary hit points equal to your Paragon level until the start of your next turn.

GENERAL MAGIC ITEMS

Not tied to any archetype — usable by any Paragon, or any class.

Cowl of the Vigilante

Uncommon, Attunement

Darkvision 60 ft. (or +30 ft. if you already have it). Advantage on Intimidation checks while worn with the hood up, against creatures that can see you.

Aegis Disc

Rare, Attunement

A returning throwing shield: +1 AC. Melee or thrown attack, 1d8 + Str bludgeoning; returns to your hand after the attack resolves.

Adamant Claws

Rare, Attunement

Magic slashing claws (1d6); climb any surface without a check. Once per long rest, bonus action: regain 2d8 + Paragon level hit points.

Stormcaller's Hammer

Rare, Attunement (Str 15+)

Returning magic maul (2d6 bludgeoning). Once per short rest, on a hit: 2d8 lightning to the target and each creature within 10 feet (Dex save for half).

Utility Harness

Rare

6 compartments. Once per long rest, bonus action: produce a smoke grenade, grapnel line, flashbang, or lockpick set as if you'd been carrying it.

Ring of the Unbreakable Ward

Very Rare, Attunement

Once per long rest, reaction: reduce damage to yourself or an ally within 30 feet by 4d10.

Speed Force Anklets

Very Rare, Attunement

+15 ft. walking speed. Once per short rest, bonus action: Dash for free, without provoking opportunity attacks this turn.

Gauntlets of the Iron Sentinel

Legendary, Attunement

Action: ranged spell attack (+7), 4d10 force damage, 3/long rest. Resistance to nonmagical B/P/S damage while worn.

Amulet of the Cosmic Sight

Legendary, Attunement

Cast detect magic at will. Once per long rest, cast dispel magic (as 5th level, no slot required).

Shield of Freedom

Legendary, Attunement

+2 AC. Returning thrown weapon: 1d10 + Str force damage. Once per short rest, reaction: grant an ally within 30 feet resistance to the triggering damage instead of yourself.

Lock of Phoenix Hair

Legendary, Attunement

Resistance to fire damage. Once per long rest, if reduced to 0 HP, rise instead with half your maximum HP in a burst of flame — 3d6 fire damage to each creature within 10 feet.